

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting complex litigation, preparing hearing bundles and court materials, managing case files under deadline pressure, and advising clients on sensitive matters. Experienced across disputes work at BCLP, family and welfare matters at Citizens Advice, and data-privacy advisory work at Q-Legal. Strong drafter of procedural documents and correspondence, with careful document management skills and experience communicating with vulnerable clients.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme of Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Interviews clients across welfare, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies, and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, and maintains confidential case records to deadline across a high volume of concurrent matters
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria, identifies evidential gaps, and researches complex points of law
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options; translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with court materials, skeleton arguments and court filings
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Maintained matter records via iManage; managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines
- Assisted with hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Prepared client notes and ensured procedural steps were completed on time

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline; coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission

- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Q-Legal · Remote

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified legal and compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report and correspondence drafting; document redaction; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters